

The actual cost

The ring starts at Rs. 28,900 for the silver and black variants, going up to Rs. 39,900 for the premium finishes. Add the subscription at Rs. 599 per month after the first free month, and you are looking at roughly Rs. 35,000 in year one for the base model. Without the subscription you only get three days of data history and the three headline scores, which strips out most of what makes the ring worth owning. Budget for it from the start.

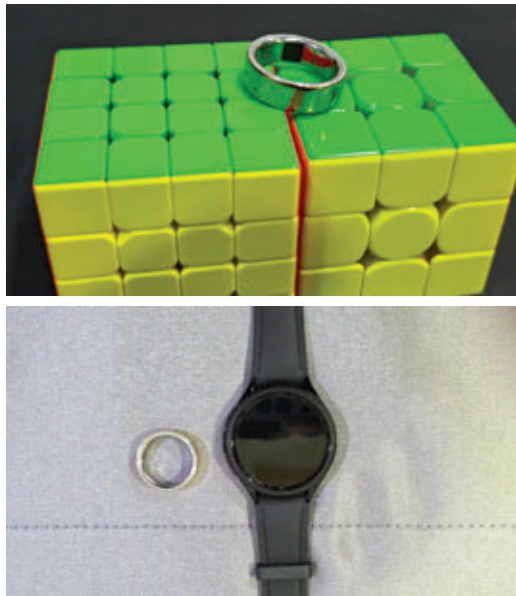
One practical note for Indian buyers: get the sizing kit first. It costs Rs. 999 and will save you from the considerably worse situation of getting the wrong size on a Rs. 28,900 purchase and that cost also get adjusted in the final price of the ring.

The app experience

Built around three scores you see every morning: Readiness, Sleep, and Activity. Readiness is the one I became slightly obsessed with. It pulls together resting heart rate, HRV balance, body temperature, sleep quality, sleep regularity, previous day activity, and respiratory rate to tell you how ready your body is to take on the day. Each contributing factor is tappable so you can understand exactly why your score landed where it did. It is not a number you can easily manufacture by just sleeping more or working out harder, which means when it moves, you pay attention.

The sleep breakdown sits underneath that. You get your sleep stages charted across the night: REM, light, deep, and awake, alongside body movement, breathing regularity, disturbance timestamps, and HRV tracked across the full night. After two weeks of consistent use, longer-term patterns start appearing like sleep debt over the past 14 days and stress resilience trends.

After two weeks it also surfaces your cardiovascular age, which estimates arterial stiffness relative to your actual age. Mine came in 3.5 years older than I am, sitting within the ideal range. I



will be honest, I do not fully know how much weight to give that number. Oura derives it from HRV and resting heart rate patterns over time, so it is not arbitrary, but it is also not a cardiology report. I found it useful as a directional signal rather than a hard verdict, something to watch trend over months rather than act on immediately.

Oura also has an AI advisor that reads your data and offers personalised suggestions. It works, it is fine, and I would not miss it if it were not there. The data itself is the interesting part. The chatbot layer on top of it felt like it was trying a little too hard.

Where it falls short

The Oura Ring 4 is not trying to be a sports watch and should not be judged like one. But the gaps are worth knowing about clearly.

Step counting is less accurate than the Galaxy Watch. It tends to overcount or undercount depending on the activity. For workouts, the watch gives you pace, distance, and cadence. The ring gives you none of that. If you run, cycle, or swim and care about performance metrics, the ring isn't it. The ring sits in the wellness category: sleep, recovery, stress, and fatigue. Outside that lane it does not pretend to compete.

The ring also has no vibration motor and no LED display, so there are no notifications, no alarms, no glanceable stats. Entirely passive. Some people will find this freeing. Others will find it limiting. Know which one you are before buying.

And then there is the speed-cubing problem. I solve cubes competitively and wearing the ring on my left ring finger means it rubs against my middle and index fingers during solves, which messes with my grip and affects my times. I now take it off before sitting down to cube. A minor inconvenience in the grand scheme, but worth knowing if any of your hobbies involve precise finger movement.

Battery life

Rated at eight days. In three weeks of real use I consistently hit seven days per charge, with the charger taking about an hour to top it up. Compact puck, USB-C, no complaints. It is one of the better battery experiences in wearables and one of the least interesting things to write about, which is how it should be.

So, who is it for?

The Oura Ring 4 is not a fitness tracker that also does sleep. It is a recovery and wellness tracker that logs your workouts. That distinction sounds small but it reframes how you use it. You stop asking what you burned and ask if you were ready to burn it in the first place.

If you want a smartwatch replacement, look elsewhere. If you want pace and cadence and GPS routes, look elsewhere. If you want to understand what your body is actually doing when you are not watching it, and you want a device comfortable enough to wear through workouts, every night of sleep, and every sweaty Mumbai afternoon without once wanting to take it off, this ring makes a serious case for itself. **D**

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